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BACKGROUND GUIDE



CCC

**Agenda: Response to the Infiltration in
Jammu and Kashmir**



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Freeze Date: 5 August 1965

Dear Delegates,

We're excited to have you on board for what promises to be three days of fast-paced, intense, and engaging debate. Crisis committees are unique, they require quick thinking, strategic planning, and a deep understanding of your portfolio. You won't just debate policy; you'll be shaping events as they unfold in real time.

This background guide is here to help you start your preparation, but it's not the full picture. We encourage you to research beyond it, understand your role, your interests, and how you might respond when things don't go to plan.

We know this might be a new experience for some of you, and that's okay. We're here to support you. If you have any questions, don't hesitate to reach out, we're always happy to help.

We look forward to seeing the creativity, diplomacy, and energy you bring to the committee. Let's make this a memorable experience!

Best regards,

The Executive Board

Continuous Crisis Committee



Introduction

On 5 August 1965, reports start coming in of armed men moving through Jammu and Kashmir, most of them from areas close to the Ceasefire Line. That is where the committee begins, not with a war, not with an invasion, but with reports.

Nobody in Delhi can yet say who these men are, how many crossed, what they intend to do, or whether anyone across the line put them there. That uncertainty is not a gap in this guide. It is the crisis.

India has to answer the incursion without walking into a larger war with Pakistan, and it has to do so in a region whose status Pakistan has never accepted as settled. Eighteen years of unresolved argument, a border clash that ended only weeks ago, and four major powers with opinions about the subcontinent all sit behind that decision.

Everything you decide must rest on what your character could plausibly have known on the morning of 5 August 1965.

Why Kashmir Is Disputed

When British India was partitioned in August 1947, the rulers of the princely states had to choose between India and Pakistan. Most chose quickly. Jammu and Kashmir did not.

The state had a Muslim-majority population and a Hindu ruler, Maharaja Hari Singh, who wanted neither option and spent the autumn trying to stay independent. That ended in October 1947, when armed tribal groups crossed into Kashmir from the direction of Pakistan and began moving on Srinagar. With the capital threatened, Hari Singh asked India for military help and signed the Instrument of Accession. Indian troops flew in the next day.



Pakistan rejected the whole sequence, arguing that a ruler could not sign away the future of a population that had never been consulted. The fighting that followed lasted more than a year, drew in regular forces, and ended with neither side holding the whole territory. Both countries have been living inside that unfinished result ever since.

The United Nations, the Ceasefire Line, and UNMOGIP

India took the dispute to the Security Council in 1948. The UN called for the fighting to stop and outlined a path that would eventually let Kashmiris vote on their own future, but the path had preconditions, chiefly the withdrawal of forces, and India and Pakistan could never agree on who withdrew first or what security would look like while it happened. The vote was never held, and the framework has been deadlocked ever since.

The Ceasefire itself took effect on 1 January 1949. Later that year the Karachi Agreement turned it into the Ceasefire Line, which is worth understanding precisely: it is not a border. It marks where two armies stopped, running through mountains that nobody drew it for, crossed by passes and shepherd tracks that no army can seal.

Monitoring it is the job of UNMOGIP, the United Nations Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan. Its observers can investigate incidents and file reports; they cannot stop anyone. That sounds like a weakness, and militarily it is, but in a crisis built on competing accusations, the side that controls what the observers see and record holds something valuable.



The Two Positions

India's case is that accession was legally complete in 1947, that Jammu and Kashmir is part of the Union, and that the UN framework collapsed because its first condition, Pakistani withdrawal, was never met. On that reading, infiltration is not a dispute to be negotiated. It is an attack on Indian territory.

Pakistan's case is that a signature obtained under military pressure settled nothing, that self-determination is still owed, and that the Indian administration of the Valley has quietly foreclosed a question the world once promised to ask. On that reading, unrest in Kashmir is not something Pakistan manufactures. It is something Indian rule produces.

Neither side is going to be argued out of its position in this committee. What matters is that both positions are sincerely held by the people holding them, which is precisely why a few hundred armed men in the mountains can turn into something much larger within a week.

The Talks That Failed

The two governments did try. The most serious effort ran through 1962 and 1963, with Swaran Singh negotiating for India and Zulfikar Ali Bhutto for Pakistan across several rounds.

The rounds produced nothing. The gap between the positions was too wide, and the talks ended without agreement. Their real legacy is a mood: by 1965, both capitals had largely stopped believing that ordinary diplomacy would ever resolve Kashmir. Once a government stops believing that, it starts thinking about what else might happen.



1962 and the Shifting Balance

India's war with China in 1962 was a defeat, and a humiliating one. What followed was a crash expansion of the armed forces, new equipment, and a deepening of India's defence relationships, with the United States and Britain, and increasingly with the Soviet Union.

Pakistan watched all of this with alarm. Weapons supplied to India for use against China could obviously be used elsewhere, and Pakistan drew its own conclusion, moving steadily closer to Peking.

The result is that neither country can now plan against the other in isolation. India has to weigh every division it moves west against what China might do in the north. Pakistan has to weigh its Chinese alignment against its American one. Any calculation made in this committee that ignores the third party is incomplete.

The Rann of Kutch

The clearest warning sign is only weeks old. In the spring of 1965, Indian and Pakistani forces fought in the Rann of Kutch, a disputed salt marsh between Gujarat and Sindh, terrain that strongly favoured the Pakistani side and produced an Indian performance nobody in Delhi enjoyed explaining. British involvement eventually brought it to a stop, and a Ceasefire took effect on 30 June 1965.

Five weeks later, this crisis begins. The two countries enter it having just shot at each other, with each side having drawn lessons about the other's nerve, and with an Indian government that has already been accused at home of backing down once.



Inside Jammu and Kashmir

It would be convenient to treat Kashmir as terrain. It is not.

Opinion within the state runs in several directions at once: staying with India, greater autonomy, joining Pakistan, holding the vote that was once promised, or full independence. Layered over all of it is real dissatisfaction with the local administration, which many Kashmiris regard as imposed rather than chosen.

This is the part of the crisis that decides it. An infiltration campaign that finds a sympathetic population becomes an uprising; one that finds an indifferent or hostile population becomes a few thousand men starving in the mountains. Every action either government takes inside the Valley, searches, arrests, curfews, how prisoners are treated, how Friday prayers are policed, pushes the population one way or the other.

The Map

You do not need to memorise passes and ridgelines. You do need to know why a handful of places keep appearing in the signals.

Srinagar is the political and administrative heart of the Indian-administered state, and the obvious prize for anyone trying to make a point. Gulmarg, west of Srinagar and close to the line, is where several of the current reports originate. Uri sits near the line and sits astride a route toward Srinagar. Poonch and Rajouri are hard mountain country with more crossing points than anyone can see. Akhnoor matters for its road links, look at what connects to what before you decide it doesn't concern you. Kargil and Ladakh carry an extra weight the others don't, because of what lies beyond them to the north.



Where Things Stand on 5 August 1965

Armed groups are reportedly operating inside Jammu and Kashmir. Authorities are investigating movement near Gulmarg and at other points along the line. Beyond that, the picture is fragmentary.

The committee does not know who the infiltrators are, how many entered, where they all are, what they are trying to achieve, whether they have local support, or whether Pakistan put them there as part of something larger. Some of that will emerge during crisis. Some of it will emerge wrongly at first.

Resist the urge to fill the gaps from memory. Anything you can look up today about what this turned out to be is unavailable to your character this morning, and a committee that skips the discovery phase loses the most interesting part of the crisis.

The Choices, and the Trap Inside Them

India's problem is calibration. Respond too lightly and armed groups move deeper, communications get cut, and the situation is beyond recovery before anyone in Delhi admits it is happening. Respond too heavily and you may hand Pakistan exactly the wider confrontation it might be looking for, and hand the Security Council a story in which India is the party that escalated.

The options are familiar: more patrolling, securing roads and bridges and communication lines, moving reinforcements toward affected sectors, serious intelligence work, interrogating anyone captured, involving UNMOGIP, approaching Pakistan diplomatically, or striking harder and further than any of that. None is free. Reinforcements are also a signal. Involving the UN is also an admission. Diplomacy is also delay.



A note on how this committee is structured. You are the Cabinet of India, and only that. There is no Pakistani room. Rawalpindi's decisions are made by the Executive Board, and they will be made in response to what you do, which means Pakistan will not be reasonable because you were reasonable, and will not necessarily be reckless because you were firm. You cannot negotiate with it across a table. You can only send it signals, read the ones it sends back, and act on your own estimate of what it wants.

That estimate is your central intellectual task. Spend real time on it. Ask what Pakistan is actually trying to achieve, what it believes about Indian resolve after the Rann of Kutch, what its relationships with Peking and Washington permit and forbid, and what it does if its plan in the Valley fails. A cabinet that builds a coherent theory of the adversary will make far better decisions than one that simply reacts to each report as it arrives.

And keep hold of the real danger, which is that nobody has to choose a war for one to occur. The sequence runs: infiltration, security operations, more troops near the line, contact between them, artillery, and then something no capital selected. Every step is reasonable given the step before it. So when you write a directive, do not only ask what it accomplishes. Ask how it reads from the other side of the line, to people who already assume the worst of you.

Outside Powers



The United Nations will investigate Ceasefire violations and push to cool things down; expect the Security Council to become an arena quickly. The United States has working relationships with both countries, is preoccupied elsewhere, and has limited appetite for another South Asian war. The United Kingdom retains real influence and has just demonstrated it by helping end the Rann of Kutch fighting. The Soviet Union has deepening ties with India but also an interest in being seen as a broker. China is hostile to India after 1962 and increasingly close to Pakistan. None of these governments will act on your behalf, and several will act on their own timetable regardless of what this Cabinet prefers.

Know what each of them wants from India and Pakistan. You do not need to become a Cold War historian.

Preparing for Committee

This guide gives you the situation. Your portfolio is your own work, and it is where the difference between an adequate delegate and a good one becomes visible.

Research what your office actually is: its stated position on Kashmir, and more usefully, its formal powers, what you can order on your own authority, what requires the Cabinet's approval, and what you can only ask someone else to do. A directive that exceeds your portfolio will simply fail. Then look at where your ministry or command stood during the 1947-48 war, how it read the UN resolutions, what it did in 1962, and what it did during Kutch. Finally, answer the question that matters most: what would somebody in your chair realistically know on the morning of 5 August 1965, and through which channel would they learn it?



Military and intelligence portfolios should go further into command structures, the formations actually present in the state, the road and communication network, and the geography. Political and diplomatic portfolios should go deeper into government policy, relations with the major powers, parliamentary and press pressure, and public opinion, including opinion inside the Valley, which is not the same thing as opinion in Delhi.

Some questions worth sitting with beforehand: Who are these men, and what evidence would actually establish outside involvement rather than merely assert it? How do you fight armed groups without turning the population against you? Do you reinforce, and how visibly? Do you bring in the UN, and what does that cost you? How do you handle rumour and panic in Srinagar? What channel exists for reaching Rawalpindi once shooting starts, and who in this room controls it? Which of your own likely actions is most capable of causing a war nobody wanted? And, the one most committees never ask, what would ending this well actually look like, and who would have to be persuaded that it was a success?

Most of these have no clean answer. You will decide without enough information, which is the condition every person in this Cabinet was working under.

The Freeze Date

The committee opens on 5 August 1965. Nothing after that has happened.

That rules out later battles and operations, troop movements, UN decisions, Ceasefire agreements, territorial changes, speeches, diplomatic settlements, casualty figures, and above all the eventual outcome of 1965. It also rules out treating the identity, scale and design of the infiltration as known simply because it is known today. If any of it becomes available, it will reach you through crisis, and it may reach you incomplete or wrong.



Closing

By August 1965, India and Pakistan have argued about Jammu and Kashmir for nearly eighteen years. They have fought a war over it, failed to negotiate their way out of it, and traded fire in the Rann of Kutch weeks ago.

Now there are armed men in the mountains and nobody can say how many.

This committee is not here to reproduce what happened. It is here to decide what India does next. **Timeline-**

Date

Event

Aug 1947

Partition. Jammu and Kashmir does not accede to either dominion; Hari Singh seeks to remain independent

Oct 1947

Armed tribal groups cross into Kashmir and advance on Srinagar; Hari Singh signs the Instrument of Accession; Indian troops airlifted in



Jan 1948	India refers the dispute to the UN Security Council
1 Jan 1949	Ceasefire ends the first Kashmir war
27 Jul 1949	Karachi Agreement establishes the Ceasefire Line; UNMOGIP tasked with monitoring it
8-9 Aug 1953	Sheikh Abdullah, the Valley's dominant political figure, is dismissed as Prime Minister of the state and arrested
Oct-Nov 1962	Sino-Indian War. Indian defeat; crash expansion of the armed forces begins
Mar 1963	Sino-Pakistani boundary agreement; Pakistan and China draw closer
1962-63	Six rounds of India-Pakistan talks on Kashmir (Swaran Singh and Bhutto) collapse without agreement
Dec 1963	The Moi-e-Muqaddas is stolen from the Hazratbal shrine and recovered days



Jan 1964	later. Enormous crowds fill Srinagar; the administration nearly loses control of the Valley
27 May 1964	Death of Jawaharlal Nehru
Jun 1964	Lal Bahadur Shastri becomes Prime Minister
Dec 1964	Articles 356 and 357 of the Indian Constitution extended to Jammu and Kashmir, permitting central rule
Mar-Apr 1965	The state's constitution is amended: the Sadr-i-Riyasat becomes a Governor appointed by the Centre, and the state's Prime Minister becomes a Chief Minister
Apr-Jun 1965	Fighting in the Rann of Kutch; British-brokered Ceasefire takes effect 30 June
May 1965	Sheikh Abdullah, released the previous year, is re-arrested and detained



outside the state. The Valley has been sullen since.

5 Aug 1965

Committee convenes

Important Information and Formats-

Here is some important information that is of great importance. Please go through what is given below and follow the formats given here in the committee.

Directives-

A directive is a document formatted in a particular manner that provides instructions to your government on a specific plan of action or set of actions. These plans or set of actions must be aimed primarily at advancing your foreign policy and secondarily at resolving the crisis at hand. The best directives are those that can achieve both the advancement of foreign policy and the resolution of the crisis at the same time. However not all portfolios or States would be in a position to aim to write such directives due to their position(s), stakes, and objectives in the given crisis. Directives can be sent in by an individual delegate or by a group of delegates. When sent in by a group of delegates, it is called a joint directive.



Overt Directive

All directives are by default considered overt in nature. Information on both the execution and the outcome of such a directive shall be communicated to the committee.

Covert Directive

If you want your government to take certain actions but do not wish to have the involvement of your government in taking such actions disclosed, you should send covert directives. Only the outcome of such directives will be communicated either to the delegate from whom the directive was received or to the committee as a whole. Such directives are usually used for espionage, sabotage, intelligence, and other such operations the details of which should ideally not be disclosed to the public. If an action is conspicuous and cannot be carried out covertly, it would not matter if it was enclosed within a covert directive, its execution and outcome will be communicated to the entire committee.



Tips on Directive Writing

- Each directive must be aiming to achieve one specific, well defined objective using the most effective and resource-efficient means. There may be secondary objectives for each action taken but the achievement of a secondary objective must always be seen as an added benefit, not an absolute requirement for the plan of action mentioned in the directive.
- Directives must be as detailed as possible. However, details that are redundant and superfluous must be avoided. For example, if a directive's aim is to buy your President a burger, it can have details with regards to what kind of burger to buy, where and when to buy it, etcetera. Details such as which service executive to buy it from, the clothing of the person buying the burger, the payment method etcetera would not be required.
- If you require your government to initiate a complex mission or set of actions, divide the mission or set of actions into sensible composite parts and write a directive for each composite part separately. All the directives aimed at accomplishing said mission must be sent together or must have a mention of the name of the mission they are a part of.



- The nature of the directive (cover/overt) must be mentioned clearly. In absence of any mention of the nature of the directive, the Executive Board will assume and evaluate the directive as an overt directive.

Portfolio requests

These are communications from individual delegates to their respective governments seeking information unavailable to them at the moment based on which they can decide to take action. Such requests are encouraged only when the information sought is publicly unavailable.

Press releases

These are public statements that the delegate(s) want their government(s) to issue. These can be sent in by individual delegates or a group of delegates. If passed, these shall be publicly displayed in the committee.

Communiqués

These are secret communications that delegates can individually or collectively send to other delegates not present in their cabinet, their own government, or governments of States that may or may not be present in the committee. The content of these can include, but are not limited to negotiations, requests, threats, or demands.



Formats

1. Directives

Title: [Any title for the operation/mission - required only in case a series of directives from a single operation/mission]

Type: Covert/Overt Directive

From:

Primary objective: [A one to two line description of what you wish to accomplish using this directive.]

Secondary objective (if any): [Any objective that may also be achieved while executing this directive.] **Mission brief:** [A three to four line description of how the aforementioned objective(s) will be accomplished.]

Plan of action: [A detailed description of what you wish your government or its specific agency/agencies to accomplish the aforementioned objective(s).] **Additional information (if any):** [Any additional details that you wish to convey.] **References (not mandatory):** [Sources of information using which you suggested the above plan of action.]



2. Portfolio Requests

From: Delegate of

To: [Designation of the person within your government who has the authority to provide the information you are seeking.]

[Question or query]

3. Press Release/Statement

From:

[Statement]

4. Communiqués



From: Delegate of

To: [Name of the country/designation to which you wish to send the communiqué] [Message]